

>> exercise and posture

Exercise benefits your mind as well as your body. It makes you feel more energized and better prepared for whatever life throws at you. If you cultivate good postural habits, you will see the benefits both in your everyday movements and in your appearance.



Aerobic, or cardiovascular, exercise simply means any form of exercise that keeps the heart rate high over a sustained period of time. Aerobic literally means “with oxygen.” By increasing the heart rate and strengthening the heart (see p.188) and lungs, the body is able to use oxygen more efficiently. The system known as ‘aerobic exercise’ was first developed in 1968 by Dr. Kenneth H. Cooper in San Antonio, Texas. It originally consisted of exercises such as cycling, running, and swimming, but from those simple beginnings arose the aerobics exercise phenomenon we know today.

The “Talk Test”

Always work within safe limits when exercising. The simplest way of checking is to use the “Talk Test.” Quite simply, if you can talk comfortably while you are exercising, your heart rate is functioning within a safe range. If you are feeling breathless or uncomfortable, you should stop.

Correct posture

Correct posture and alignment are important not only when exercising, but also in your daily life as well. Walking, standing, carrying heavy objects, and even holding a briefcase all take their toll on the spine. With just a little effort, you can have perfect posture and a healthy spine throughout your life.

Continuous aerobic exercise enhances the production of serotonin, a neurotransmitter with effects on the brain that include mood elevation.